# THE ELON GAZETTE

*Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing*

MONDAY, OCTOBER 12, 2026


THE MORNING PICTURE

## "Prime Minister Ambani," a ship catch on the calendar, and a call to replace Zelensky

Since Friday morning, Elon Musk spent much of his time on X in a running fight with Mukesh Ambani over Starlink's stalled start in India. He addressed the Reliance chairman as "Prime Minister Ambani" on Friday, shared old reports on Reliance's political ties on Saturday and, by Sunday, was calling Ambani's online defenders an "army of Internet shills." India's communications minister answered that the country "does not allow monopoly in any sector."

On Saturday Musk joined the fan-run X Takeover at Giga Texas by video. He said the next Starship flight, "hopefully" four to six weeks away, will try to catch the ship with the launch tower, and he described Tesla's chipmaking plans. The same day he backed President Donald Trump's call for Ukraine to get a new president ("Zelensky has gone too far"), called electricity production "the best metric for the true strength of any large-scale economy," and said Grok Bot can now shop online. Tesla's Robotaxi account said more than 300 Cybercabs are now serving Austin.

I · STARLINK IN INDIA

## Musk versus Ambani, round three

*Starlink holds an Indian license but is still waiting on security clearance and spectrum. Musk blames Reliance; New Delhi says all three licensed operators are at the same stage.*

| 3 | 165+ | 5 yrs |
|---|---|---|
| Satellite operators licensed in India: Starlink, Jio Satcom, Eutelsat OneWeb | Countries where Musk says Starlink is licensed to operate | Time Musk says Starlink has spent complying with Indian rules |

### "Dear Prime Minister Ambani"

The row began midweek, when Musk said Starlink was being "blocked by certain oligarchs" keeping a "monopolistic chokehold on the Indian people," the Hindustan Times reported. On Friday he escalated with a post that Mint printed in full:

> *"Dear Prime Minister Ambani, Please accept my humble apologies for not realizing that you are the real boss of India. Naturally, you would prefer to maintain your monopolistic exploitation of the great people of India, but would you nonetheless consider allowing Starlink to compete?"*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · FRIDAY, VIA MINT

He added that areas without internet access deny "children the opportunity for education and small businesses the opportunity to sell their goods to a global market," and in a follow-up said Starlink "has proven to be essential for saving lives during natural disasters throughout the world, when all other communications systems have failed."

### New Delhi pushes back

Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia told reporters at the India Mobile Congress on Friday: "Now let me be very clear, India does not allow monopoly in any sector... even as satcom is concerned, there is not a single licensee that has been chosen." Starlink, Reliance Jio's Jio Satcom and Bharti-backed Eutelsat OneWeb all hold licences, he said; each can start once revenue-based spectrum charges are set and it meets security conditions individually. The telecom regulator and the Department of Telecommunications are "close to taking the final decision" on pricing, according to the Hindustan Times. A ministry statement a day earlier called suggestions of discrimination "baseless and misconceived."

Opposition leader Rahul Gandhi had joined in after Musk asked "Is Ambani the real boss of India?", writing: "Welcome to India, Elon. Wait till you discover the other guy."

QUICK HIT

**Saturday's exhibit.** Musk shared screenshots of a 2022 Al Jazeera report on a Reliance-funded firm boosting BJP campaigns and a 2024 Indian Express report on electoral-bond donations by a Reliance-linked company, The Hindu reported.

### "Absurd hypocrisy"

On Sunday India time, Musk turned on Ambani's defenders. India Today and The Hindu quoted the post:

> *"The ridiculous arguments by Ambani's army of Internet shills make no sense. On the one hand, they say Starlink couldn't possibly compete with the amazing low prices offered by Ambani's de facto monopoly in India and then, in the same breath, they essentially claim that Starlink would be too strong of a competitor! This is absurd hypocrisy and hyperbole."*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · VIA INDIA TODAY

He went on: "Ambani's profits will be lower, but he is not going out of business. And, obviously, if Starlink is too expensive in India, no one will buy it, so SpaceX will need to make pricing affordable." Reliance has not publicly responded, The Hindu noted.

II · X TAKEOVER AT GIGA TEXAS

# Catch the ship, make ten chips a year

*In a 41-minute video interview with Tesla Owners Silicon Valley before about 2,000 people, Musk ran from Starship to Terafab to Optimus's hand.*



The launch tower's arms catch a Super Heavy booster at Starbase, Texas, during Starship's fifth flight test on October 13, 2024. No ship has been caught yet.

PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0 (CROPPED)

### "Full recovery of an orbital class rocket"

Starship Flight 14 launched September 28, reached orbit and deployed 26 Starlink V3 satellites, though one engine shut down early, TSN Media summarized. Musk said the engine glitch "doesn't seem to be too much of an issue" and that the heat shield was robust. Of the next flight, he said:

> *"We don't know the exact launch date, but probably about four weeks or so. Four to six weeks is about right. Probably launches a little bit before Thanksgiving is my guess."*
>
> ELON MUSK · X TAKEOVER INTERVIEW, SATURDAY, VIA TSN MEDIA

"The big milestone coming up, which is hopefully flight 15, is to catch the ship, making it the first full recovery of an orbital class rocket," he added. He attributed the Flight 14 engine-out to "basically a failure in the flight computer software or engine computer software." SpaceX has not published a Flight 15 date; NASASpaceflight's unofficial schedule, based on Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) planning slides, lists it no earlier than November 8, The Vanguard reported.

### Chips, robots and the Roadster

According to the interview summary on CEOInterviews, Musk said Tesla wants to turn out ten chip designs a year at a fast-iteration fab at Giga Texas, against an industry pace of about one every two years. He conceded he still has "a lot to learn about chip making," All Things Elon reported, with Terafab starting on conventional equipment before moving to custom machines. China's magnet export ban set Optimus back two to three months, he said, and the hand remains the hardest part. On robotaxis, he said he wants to avoid any accident at all because of the headlines and regulatory risk.

Musk dismissed rivals' polished robot demo videos: real AI, Tesla Mag reported, means showing a robot something it has never seen and watching it still work. He defended AI music ("The AI music is really good") and said SpaceX's focus on Starship is "to make sure everything is as safe as possible." Tesla unveils the new Roadster on Thursday, October 15, at 9 p.m. EDT, Tesla Mag noted.



Building 1 at Tesla's Gigafactory Texas near Austin, shown on June 17, 2022. The factory hosted Saturday's X Takeover.
PHOTO: LARRY D. MOORE / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0 (CROPPED)

### Cybercabs and "Tesla SI"

Between talks, Tesla's Robotaxi account said: "One month after launch, we've scaled to 300+ Cybercabs serving Austin – an 8x increase in 30 days." Tesla AI head Ashok Elluswamy added that Cybercabs are "everywhere in Austin now. Dallas soon," TeslaNorth reported; no Dallas date was given. Tesla's AI team now posts as @TeslaSI, for superintelligence, a rebrand All Things Elon tied to the weekend.

III · UKRAINE

## "Zelensky has gone too far"

*Musk sided with Trump on replacing Ukraine's president, reviving fears in Kyiv about Starlink. A presidential adviser says a cutoff is unlikely.*

### Four words on X

On Saturday, hours after Trump told reporters at Joint Base Andrews "I think it's time for Ukraine to get a new president," Musk shared video of the remarks and wrote "Zelensky has gone too far," bne IntelliNews reported, citing the Kyiv Post. Trump was angry that Ukrainian drones kept striking Russian refineries: "I said to him, 'Do what you want. Don't hit refineries,' and he went out, and he hit." Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha replied that only Ukraine's voters can decide how the country is governed, the Kyiv Post reported.

Serhii "Flash" Beskrestnov, a presidential adviser on defense technology, told Euromaidan Press that SpaceX will not cut Ukraine off because Musk "is first of all a businessman" and Ukraine brings significant revenue. Nobody in Washington has threatened to switch Starlink off, bne noted, but Musk refused in August to let Starlink guide strikes deep inside Russia. Zelensky said on October 4 that Ukraine is working on a satellite system of its own.

IV · ENERGY & AI

## Watts as the measure of a nation, and a bot that shops

*Two Saturday posts drew wide attention: one on electricity and wealth, one on handing Grok Bot a credit card.*

### "The best metric"

Quote-posting an a16z chart of electricity use per person against GDP per person, Musk wrote: "Electricity production is the best metric for the true strength of any large-scale economy, in my opinion." The chart, built on World Bank data for 2021, shows no wealthy country with low electricity use, Marca reported; Norway and the United States sit at the top and Somalia and Burundi near the bottom. Marca paired it with former Intel CEO Pat Gelsinger's warning, via a16z, that power generation may become AI's real bottleneck: "Why build a new data center and buy a million GPUs if I can't power them?"

### Grok Bot goes shopping

"To buy stuff, you can just take a picture of your credit card, drop it in the chat and Grok @Bot will scour the Internet for the best deal on the item you want and order it," Musk posted Saturday afternoon. Replying to a user, he added: "I just ordered LEGO and Grok bought it from the LEGO website." TeslaNorth noted he did not say whether the feature is live for everyone, which plans include it, or what spending safeguards exist.

QUICK HIT

**Grok on stage.** At X Takeover, Nicki Minaj said using Grok's new agent "made me feel like I was cheating in life," Tesla Mag reported. Maye Musk spoke about her new book, Timeless.

# On the record

*One live appearance this weekend, plus a week of India coverage driven by Musk's posts.*

### X Takeover: "What Comes Next for Humanity"

Saturday, October 10, 2026

Video interview with Tesla Owners Silicon Valley at Giga Texas, about 41 minutes: Tesla's near-death moments in 2008 and 2018, Starship Flight 14 and the planned ship catch, SpaceX's AI plans and the Cursor acquisition, AI safety, chipmaking at Giga Texas, Optimus, Cybercab and the Roadster. CEOInterviews summary · Tesla Mag · TSN Media

### India press: the Starlink row October 9–11, 2026

Musk's posts and Scindia's reply were covered across Indian media. Mint · Hindustan Times · The Hindu · India Today

### Ukraine coverage October 11, 2026

Reaction in Kyiv to Musk's post on Zelensky. Kyiv Post · bne IntelliNews · Euromaidan Press

## Takeaways

1. Musk is now attacking Mukesh Ambani by name almost daily; India's government says Starlink is at the same stage as its two licensed rivals, pending security checks and spectrum pricing.
2. Starship Flight 15 is pitched as the first try at catching the ship, "hopefully" in four to six weeks; unofficial planning dates point to November 8 at the earliest.
3. Tesla's chip ambitions center on fast iteration at Giga Texas, with Musk openly saying he is still learning the craft.
4. Musk's "Zelensky has gone too far" post revived Ukrainian worries about Starlink; Kyiv's adviser expects no cutoff.
5. Next on the calendar: the Roadster unveil on Thursday, October 15, at 9 p.m. EDT.

## Sources

Posts by @elonmusk, @robotaxi and @aelluswamy, as quoted by the outlets below.

Mint · Hindustan Times · The Hindu · India Today · TSN Media · The Vanguard · CEOInterviews · Tesla Mag · All Things Elon · TeslaNorth · bne IntelliNews · Kyiv Post · Euromaidan Press · Marca · Photos: Wikimedia Commons (Steve Jurvetson, CC BY 2.0; Larry D. Moore, CC BY 4.0)

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